

The Moon Who Wanted to Play



A StorySprout Press Book





Every night, when the world went to sleep, Luna the Moon woke up. She loved her job of lighting the way for owls and dreamers.





"It looks so much fun down there," Luna sighed. "I want to run in the grass and hear the children laugh."



"Why can't I play in the daytime?" she asked her friend Twinkle the Star.



"Because you're the Moon!" Twinkle giggled. "You'd get a sunburn! Plus, who would watch over the night?"



Luna didn't care. She waited and waited until the morning light began to peek over the hills.



BOOM! Sol the Sun rose into the sky, big and bright and warm. "Good morning, world!" he cheered.



"Sol! Wait!" Luna called out. "Can I stay and play today?"



Sol looked at Luna with surprise. "Stay? But Luna, you need your rest. The night is long and quiet."





Sol thought for a moment. "Very well, Luna. You may stay. But remember, the day is very different from the night."



Luna was so happy! She stayed in the sky as the children came out to play.
She saw Milly running with her kite.



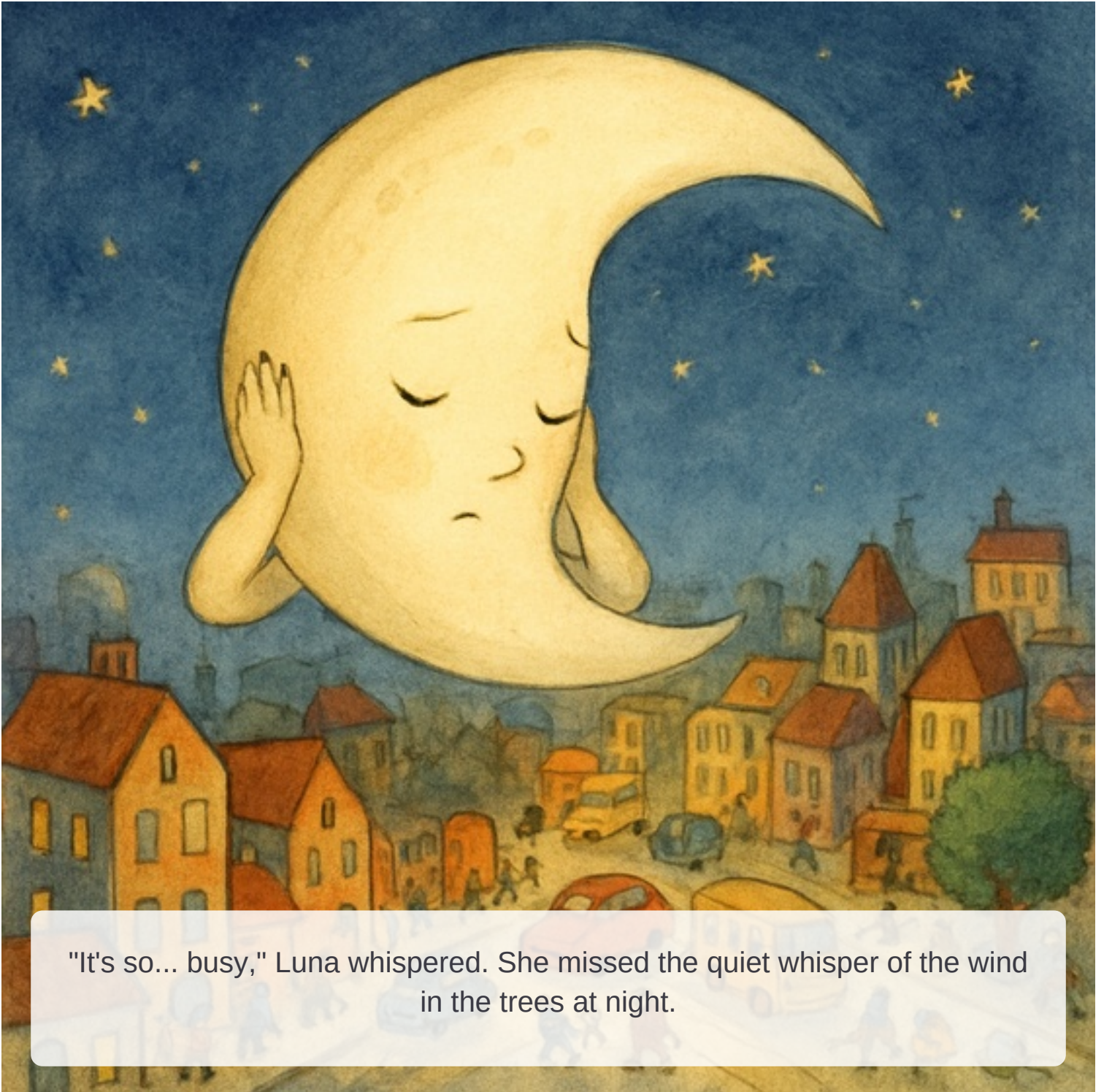
"Look! The Moon is still there!" Milly shouted, pointing up. "Hello, Moon!"



But as the day grew hotter, Luna began to feel very tired. The sun was so bright, it made her silvery light hard to see.



She tried to hear the children's laughter, but the world was so noisy! Cars honked, dogs barked, and lawnmowers whirled.



"It's so... busy," Luna whispered. She missed the quiet whisper of the wind in the trees at night.



The flowers were beautiful, but they didn't glow like the moonflowers she knew. Everything was so bright, it hurt her eyes.



"Sol was right," Luna sighed. "The day is wonderful, but I don't belong here.
I'm a creature of the quiet and the stars."



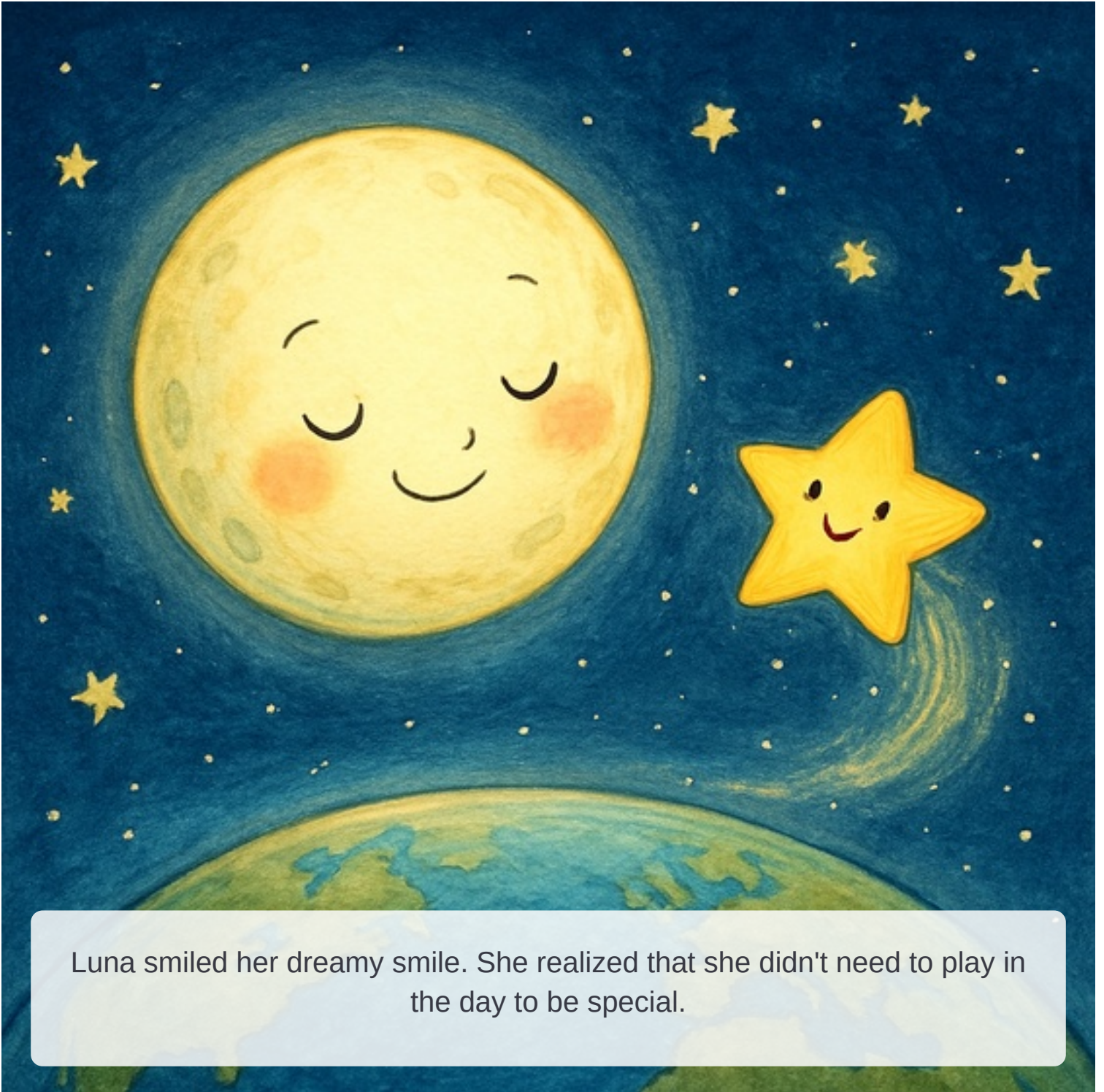
As the sun began to set, Sol looked at Luna. "Are you ready to wake up the night, Luna?"



"Yes, Sol," Luna said, feeling her strength return as the sky grew dark. "The night is waiting for me."



She saw Milly getting ready for bed. Milly looked up and waved one last time. "Goodnight, Moon! I'm glad you're back."



Luna smiled her dreamy smile. She realized that she didn't need to play in the day to be special.



She had the best job in the world—watching over the dreams of children
and lighting the way through the night.

